

Problem 2: GaeilGo Doesn't Go

(20 marks)

Everybody and everything in Ireland warmly welcomes visitors. Well, almost everything, as Aalok finds out when he decides to visit; it seems impossible to figure out the pronunciation of Gaeilge² words from their spelling! Aalok turns to his trusty pronunciation app called “GaeilGo” for help.

Given below are some Gaeilge words and their pronunciations. The pronunciations use the International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA), but knowledge of IPA is not required to solve this problem, except that the ' mark before a syllable means the syllable is stressed.

¹Jowulu, sometimes also referred to as Jɔ or Samogho, is a language of the Mande family spoken in Mali and Burkina Faso by around 10,000 to 15,000 people.

²“Gaeilge” is the Irish word for “Irish”, the native language of Ireland.

Gaeilge word	Pronunciation	Gaeilge word	Pronunciation
scuab	/s ^ʲ kuəb ^ʲ /	fluirít	/f ^ʲ l ^ʲ uə ^ʲ ˈr ^ʲ i:t ^ʲ /
scéimh	/ʃce:v ^ʲ /	nialas	/ˈn ^ʲ iəl ^ʲ əs ^ʲ /
bliain	/b ^ʲ l ^ʲ iən ^ʲ /	toscaire	/ˈt ^ʲ ɔs ^ʲ ˌkəɾ ^ʲ ə/
leaid	/l ^ʲ ad ^ʲ /	tacar	/ˈt ^ʲ akəɾ ^ʲ /
gocarsach	/ˈg ^ʲ ɔkəɾ ^ʲ s ^ʲ əx ^ʲ /	deoire	/ˈd ^ʲ o:r ^ʲ ə/
neachtar	/n ^ʲ axt ^ʲ əɾ ^ʲ /	neodrú	/ˈn ^ʲ o:d ^ʲ ɾ ^ʲ u:/
geafáil	/ˈʲaf ^ʲ a:l ^ʲ /	gleo	/ʲl ^ʲ o:/
meacan	/ˈm ^ʲ akən ^ʲ /	bádchlós	/ˈb ^ʲ ad ^ʲ ˌxl ^ʲ o:s ^ʲ /
tábhacht	/ˈt ^ʲ a:v ^ʲ əxt ^ʲ /	bibe	/ˈb ^ʲ ib ^ʲ ə/
limfe	/ˈl ^ʲ im ^ʲ ʲə/	treoluas	/ˈt ^ʲ ɾ ^ʲ o:l ^ʲ uəs ^ʲ /
latrach	/ˈl ^ʲ at ^ʲ ɾ ^ʲ əx ^ʲ /	dobrón	/d ^ʲ ɔb ^ʲ ˌɾ ^ʲ o:n ^ʲ /
sintéisach	/ʃm ^ʲ ˈt ^ʲ e:ʃəx ^ʲ /	meáintréimhse	/m ^ʲ a:n ^ʲ ˈt ^ʲ ɾ ^ʲ e:v ^ʲ ʃə/
chéad	/ˌçe:d ^ʲ /	feoil	/ˈf ^ʲ o:l ^ʲ /
deaide	/ˈd ^ʲ ad ^ʲ ə/	frigiach	/ˈf ^ʲ ɾ ^ʲ ɪɡiəx ^ʲ /

Assignment 1: (13 marks)

Aalok's phone is running out of battery—but perhaps he doesn't need it anymore. How should the following Gaeilge words be pronounced? In each word, the first syllable is stressed, unless an underline indicates a different stressed syllable.

Gaeilge word	Pronunciation	Gaeilge word	Pronunciation
béarla	_____ (a) _____	móráireamh	_____ (h) _____
riachtanais	_____ (b) _____	ordóige	_____ (i) _____
spiaire	_____ (c) _____	moltóirí	_____ (j) _____
débhliantúil	_____ (d) _____	deoiseach	_____ (k) _____
luachmhar	_____ (e) _____	giar <u>á</u> ilte	_____ (l) _____
eolach	_____ (f) _____	buaibheach	_____ (m) _____
meitseáil	_____ (g) _____		

Assignment 2: (7 marks)

Explain your solution.

– Rujul Gandhi and Shardul Chiplunkar

